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## Surrender

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Free media and discipleship resources for pastors, leaders, and growing disciples.

# Surrender

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## The Pathway to Spirit-Filled Living

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Our new life in Christ is inherently supernatural because it intimately involves all three Persons of the Triune God — the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit. We enjoy fellowship with the Father and the Son in the Holy Spirit (1 John 1:3). While we relate to each Person of the Trinity, we also relate to them in distinct ways: we obey the Son as we obey the Father, follow the leading of the Holy Spirit as we follow Christ, and experience the intercession of both the Son and the Spirit on our behalf (Romans 8:27, 34).

In essence, walking with the Triune God is a lifestyle of **submitting to the will of the Father**, **abiding in Jesus Christ**, and **being filled with the Holy Spirit**. This surrendered life is the pathway to the fullness and power God desires for every believer.

### Submit to the Father

Active, willing obedience to the Father is a beautiful expression of love and trust. Jesus said, “The person who has my commandments and obeys them is the one who loves me. The one who loves me will be loved by my Father, and I will love him and will reveal myself to him” (John 14:21). And again, “If you obey my commandments, you will remain in my love, just as I have obeyed my Father’s commandments and remain in his love” (John 15:10).

Obedience does not cause the Father to love us more — His love is constant and unconditional. Rather, obedience helps us experience and enjoy His love more fully. It also opens the door for Jesus to reveal Himself to us in deeper ways. When we submit to the Father’s will, we participate in the coming of His Kingdom right where we are.

While motivations for obedience can vary — the desire for blessing, a sense of duty, or even reverent fear — the highest motivation is love. Jesus declared, “If you love me, you will keep my commandments” (John 14:15). When love for Christ is the root, obedience becomes a joyful response rather than a burdensome duty.

## **Abide in Jesus Christ**

At the moment you received Jesus as Savior and Lord, you stepped into an exciting adventure — the fulfillment of the purpose for which you were created: to glorify God by loving Him, doing His will, and enjoying Him forever. God's goal is to transform you into the likeness of His Son so that your life bears the fruit of the Spirit: "love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control" (Galatians 5:22-23).

Shortly before His crucifixion, Jesus taught His disciples how they could live fruitful lives after His departure. Using the powerful image of the vine and the branches, He said:

"I am the true vine and my Father is the gardener... Remain in me, and I will remain in you. Just as the branch cannot bear fruit by itself unless it remains in the vine, so neither can you unless you remain in me. I am the vine; you are the branches. The one who remains in me — and I in him — bears much fruit, because apart from me you can accomplish nothing" (John 15:1, 4-5).

Abiding in Christ means living in vital, continual union with Him. It involves:

- Allowing God's Word to renew your mind so you see life from His perspective.
- Maintaining a continual awareness of Christ's great love for you.
- Choosing faithful obedience as the expression of that love.

As you abide in Jesus, your life will bear much fruit, your joy will be full, and the Father will be glorified through you. This is the only path to the fruitful, fulfilling life for which you were created.

## **Be Filled with the Holy Spirit**

Jesus promised His followers, "I tell you the solemn truth, the person who believes in me will perform the miraculous deeds that I am doing, and will perform greater deeds than these, because I am going to the Father" (John 14:12). Just as Jesus lived in the power of the Holy Spirit, we too are called to live Spirit-filled lives.

The Holy Spirit plays a vital role from the moment of salvation onward. He convicts, regenerates, indwells, guides, empowers, and transforms. The indwelling of the Spirit is the mark of every true believer, but the fullness of the Spirit enables us to live the abundant, supernatural life Jesus modeled.

## **Eric Liddell's Example of Spirit-Filled Living**

In the film *Chariots of Fire*, Eric Liddell, a Scottish runner and committed Christian, feels a deep sense of divine calling. When asked about his passion for running, he replies with quiet conviction: “God made me fast. And when I run, I feel His pleasure.”

Eric's Olympic success was not driven by personal ambition alone. It flowed from a life surrendered to God. He experienced the filling and empowerment of the Holy Spirit as he ran with wholehearted joy and obedience—refusing to compromise his convictions even when it cost him. His story shows that being filled with the Spirit is not just for dramatic spiritual moments. It equips us to live out our everyday calling with supernatural joy and power. When we align our lives with God's purposes, we too can experience the deep pleasure of the Lord in whatever He has gifted and called us to do.

## **Walking with God, in Christ, by the Spirit**

As you walk in daily surrender — submitting to the will of the Father, abiding in the Son, and depending upon the Holy Spirit — you position yourself to experience the fullness of life God intends. This surrendered life is the fertile soil in which the Spirit can work most freely, producing the supernatural living and lasting fruit described in the chapters that follow.

The next chapter explores in greater detail how to be filled and empowered by the Holy Spirit, offering clear, practical steps to help you live continually under His loving leadership and power.

May you increasingly know the joy of a life fully yielded to the Triune God — Father, Son, and Holy Spirit — as He accomplishes His beautiful purposes in and through you.

So how can a person be filled and controlled by the Holy Spirit to live the supernatural life God desires for us?

# Thank you for downloading this free resource!

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Thank you again for partnering with us in the Great Commission. May the Lord continue to fill you with joy, peace, and purpose as you walk with Him.

In Christ,

**The JesusOnline Ministries Team**

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